DID YOU KNOW?

- The TTD has acquired the Geographical Indication tag for the Tirupati laddoo
- It procures about 2,700 tonnes of ghee through e-tenders every six months
- A 85,000-litre ghee tank has been built near the temple complex
- A modern flour mill has been installed that can grind up to 15,000 kg of Bengal gram (chickpea)

QUALITY CHECK

There have been instances where ingredients were identified as substandard. Each ghee consignment undergoes rigorous lab testing, including wet chemistry analysis at the TTD's Water and Food Analysis Lab

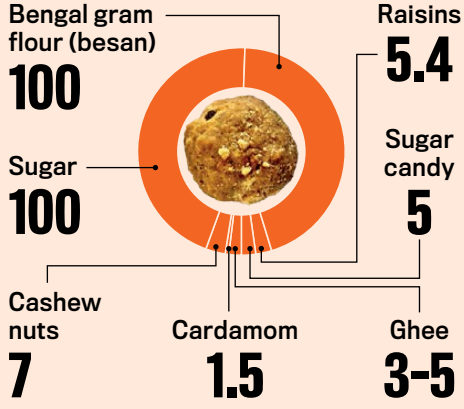
TESTING PARAMETERS

• Moisture content • Aroma • Free fatty acids • Mineral oil • Foreign colours • Melting point • Rancidity

THE SACRED INGREDIENTS

The list of ingredients and the amounts used to make the Tirupati Laddoo is called* dittam, *mentioned in the Agama shastras. Throughout its history,* dittam *has undergone six modifications. Currently, the ingredients include:

(Quantity in quintals, used in a day)



THE MANY SIZES...



SMALL

40 gm

(For free distribution among devotees)



MEDIUM

175 gm

(Cost: ₹50)



LARGE

750 gm

(Cost: ₹200)

... AND TYPES

PROKTHAM
The standard offerings distributed to pilgrims

KALYANOTSAVAM
Distributed to those who participate in the *kalyanotsavam seva*

ASTHANAM
Distributed with saffron strands, cashew and almonds on special occasions such as temple festivals

fish oil, lard or beef tallow. The report, a copy of which was accessed by INDIA TODAY, states that "the S-value (a parameter used to detect foreign fats in milk or, in this case, ghee) of all equation for sample... are falling out of the range as prescribed by method. If any S-value falls outside the corresponding limits, consider the sample to contain a foreign fat".

The report lists several ingredients which could qualify as adulterants. This list of 'foreign fats' includes rapeseed, linseed, maize germ, wheat germ, soyabean, sunflower, olive, cottonseed, fish oil, coconut and palm kernel fat, palm oil and, only towards the end,

TTD SOURCES CLAIM FREQUENT QUALITY CHECKS ARE DONE FOR THE GHEE AND OTHER INGREDIENTS AND THAT THE LADDOOS ARE STILL MADE IN THE TEMPLE KITCHENS, OBSERVING ALL TRADITIONS

beef tallow and lard. "What the report confirms is that the ghee sample was adulterated...it does not conclusively establish the presence of these ingredients," according to a source.

This is also perhaps why, two days after Naidu's claim, the executive officer of the TTD (Tirumala Tirupati Devasthanams) which manages the temple, J. Shyamala Rao, a senior IAS officer who was among the earliest appointees of the TDP government, contradicted the claim of the ghee being adulterated with animal fat. But one of the things Rao red-flagged was that the TTD had been sourcing ghee for prices ranging from Rs 320-411 a kilo when the market price was around Rs 700, so its quality had to be suspect.

While there have been adultera-